

Unit V – Presentation Skills

Communication Skills (English) — Course Code 311303 | MSBTE, K Scheme, Semester I

CO5: Deliver effective presentations in English using appropriate body language | **Learning Hours:** 6
| **Total Marks:** 8 (R:2, U:2, A:4)

Topics Covered in Unit V

Sr.No	Topic	Sub-topics
5.1	Dressing & Grooming	Dressing for the occasion, Proper grooming
5.2	Speech Writing	Situation, Salutation, Introduction, Body, Conclusion
5.3	PowerPoint Presentation	Layout, Font size, Colour combination
5.4	Kinesics	Facial expressions, Eye contact, Postures, Gestures

5.1 Dressing & Grooming

i. Dressing for the Occasion

Clothing choices must match the context, audience, and purpose of the presentation. Appropriate dressing creates a strong visual first impression, even before the speaker utters a word, and signals respect for the occasion and the audience.

- **Formal settings** (interviews, business meetings, official seminars): Wear structured, tailored clothing — formal shirts/trousers, suits, sarees or salwar-kameez in muted or neutral tones (navy, grey, black, white, beige).
- **Semi-formal settings** (classroom presentations, college seminars, workshops): Smart-casual attire is acceptable — collared shirts, trousers, or simple kurtas — while still looking neat and put together.
- **Avoid:** Flashy prints, excessive jewellery or accessories, torn/faded jeans, sneakers, shorts, or overly casual T-shirts in a professional setting.
- **Fit and condition:** Clothes should be clean, ironed, and well-fitted — neither too tight nor too loose — as wrinkled or ill-fitting clothes distract the audience and reduce credibility.
- **Colour psychology:** Darker, solid colours generally convey authority and seriousness; overly bright or clashing colours can be distracting on camera or stage.

ii. Proper Grooming

Grooming refers to personal hygiene and appearance management. It reflects self-discipline and confidence, and directly affects how credible and approachable a speaker appears to the audience.

- Neatly combed/styled hair, appropriate for a professional setting.
- Trimmed and clean nails; minimal or no chipped nail polish.
- Clean-shaven face or a neatly trimmed beard/moustache for men.
- Light, professional makeup (if worn) for women — avoiding overly bold looks.
- Minimal or no strong perfume/cologne, as strong scents can be distracting.

- Polished, clean footwear appropriate to the outfit.
- Good overall personal hygiene — fresh breath, clean hands, tidy appearance.

Why it matters: Dressing and grooming together form the non-verbal 'first impression' layer of communication. Studies on communication suggest audiences form judgments about a speaker's competence and trustworthiness within seconds of seeing them — well before the first word is spoken.

5.2 Speech Writing

Speech writing is the structured process of preparing a spoken address for a specific situation or occasion. A well-written speech follows a logical five-part structure so that the audience can easily follow and remain engaged.

i. Situation

Understanding the occasion is the first step — is it a farewell function, a welcome address, a prize distribution, a seminar, an elocution/extempore competition, or a national day celebration? The situation determines the tone (formal/informal), the length of the speech, and the emotional register (celebratory, solemn, motivational, informative).

ii. Salutation

The formal greeting with which every speech begins. It follows a protocol/order of seniority — addressing the chief guest first, followed by the principal/head of institution, teachers/staff, and finally fellow students or the general audience. Example: *"Respected Principal Sir, honourable guests, teachers, and my dear friends..."*

iii. Introduction of the Topic

A brief, engaging opening that states what the speech is about and captures audience attention immediately. Effective techniques include starting with a relevant quotation, a thought-provoking question, a surprising fact or statistic, or a short relatable anecdote connected to the topic.

iv. Description / Body

The main content of the speech, developed in logically ordered points or paragraphs. Each point should flow into the next using transition words (firstly, moreover, in addition, however). The body should include supporting examples, facts, data, or personal insights to make the speech credible and relatable, while staying within the time/word limit appropriate to the occasion.

v. Conclusion

A strong closing that summarises the key points of the speech and leaves a lasting impression. This is often achieved with an inspiring or memorable line, a call to action, or a quotation, and is typically followed by a formal vote of thanks to the audience and dignitaries.

Quick structure recap: Situation → Salutation → Introduction → Body/Description → Conclusion.

5.3 PowerPoint Presentation

A PowerPoint Presentation (PPT) is a visual aid used to support an oral presentation. Good slide design ensures the audience can read and absorb information quickly without being distracted from the speaker.

i. Layout

- Maintain a consistent structure across the deck: Title slide → Agenda/Overview → Content slides → Summary/Conclusion slide → Thank You/Q&A; slide.

- Follow the principle of 'one idea per slide' — avoid cramming multiple unrelated points onto a single slide.
- Use a consistent template, header style, and slide numbering throughout the presentation.
- Balance text with visuals (images, charts, diagrams) to avoid text-heavy, monotonous slides.
- Leave sufficient white space/margins so the slide does not look cluttered.

ii. Font Size

- Titles: approximately 36–44 pt for clear visibility.
- Body text/bullet points: approximately 24–28 pt, never smaller than 20 pt.
- Use a single, clean, easy-to-read font (e.g., Calibri, Arial) consistently across all slides — avoid decorative or script fonts for body text.
- Ensure text is large enough to be read clearly from the back of the room/venue.

iii. Colour Combination

- Use high contrast between text and background — e.g., dark text on a light background, or light text on a dark background — for maximum readability.
- Limit the palette to 2–3 complementary colours used consistently for headings, body text, and highlights.
- Avoid clashing, overly bright, or too many colours on one slide, as this strains the eyes and looks unprofessional.
- Use colour purposefully — e.g., one accent colour to highlight key data points or important words.

5.4 Kinesics

Kinesics is the study of body language — how gestures, posture, facial expressions, and eye movement communicate meaning alongside (or instead of) spoken words. In presentations, effective kinesics reinforces the verbal message and builds a stronger connection with the audience.

i. Facial Expressions

Facial expressions should genuinely match the tone and content of the message — e.g., smiling while welcoming the audience, a serious expression while discussing a grave or important issue. Genuine, natural expressions build credibility and audience trust, whereas a blank or mismatched expression can undermine the message.

ii. Eye Contact

Maintaining eye contact with the audience — rather than staring at notes, the screen, or the floor — builds trust, shows confidence, and keeps listeners engaged. The speaker should sweep their gaze naturally across different sections of the audience rather than fixating on a single person or a small group.

iii. Postures

Standing straight with shoulders back and weight evenly balanced projects confidence and authority. Slouching, leaning on furniture, or shifting weight repeatedly can signal nervousness or a lack of preparation. An open posture — arms uncrossed, body facing the audience — signals openness and approachability.

iv. Gestures

Purposeful hand movements can be used to emphasize key points, indicate sequence/numbers, or illustrate size and direction. Gestures should appear natural and controlled — excessive fidgeting, aggressive pointing, or repetitive unconscious movements (like clicking a pen) distract the audience and should be avoided.

Summary: Kinesics = Facial Expressions + Eye Contact + Postures + Gestures — together these form the non-verbal channel that supports and strengthens spoken communication during a presentation.

Relevant LLOs: LLO 11 (Introduce oneself and others), LLO 12 (Prepare a PowerPoint presentation), LLO 16 (Deliver oral presentations using correct grammar and appropriate body language) — all mapped to CO5.